```
$ ./gradlew test --tests BookValidationTests
```

3.4.2 Integration tests with @SpringBootTest

Integration tests cover the interactions among software components, and in Spring they require an application context to be defined. The `spring-boot-starter-test` dependency also imports the test utilities from Spring Framework and Spring Boot.

Spring Boot offers a powerful `@SpringBootTest` annotation that you can use on a test class to bootstrap an application context automatically when running tests. The configuration used to create the context can be customized if needed. Otherwise, the class annotated with `@SpringBootApplication` will become the configuration source for component scanning and properties, including the usual auto-configuration provided by Spring Boot.

When working with web applications, you can run tests on a mock web environment or a running server. You can configure that by defining a value for the `webEnvironment` attribute that the `@SpringBootTest` annotation provides, as shown in table 3.2.

When using a mock web environment, you can rely on the `MockMvc` object to send HTTP requests to the application and check their results. For environments with a running server, the `TestRestTemplate` utility lets you perform REST calls to an application running on an actual server. By inspecting the HTTP responses, you can verify that the API works as intended.

Table 3.2 A Spring Boot integration test can be initialized with a mock web environment or a running server.